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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

Email: [REDACTED]

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General Comment

Syntonym submits these comments to the Office of Science and Technology Policy in support of an AI Action Plan that solidifies America's global leadership in AI while ensuring privacy and security in visual data collection and processing.

As an AI company specializing in lossless anonymization, Syntonym develops technologies that enable enterprises to leverage camera data for AI advancements without compromising privacy or security. Our proprietary solutions remove facial biometric identifiers while maintaining data utility, preventing unauthorized identification and mitigating mass surveillance risks. Through collaborations with automotive manufacturers and technology developers, we emphasize the critical need for stringent privacy and security measures in visual data collection, particularly in the automotive sector.

Regulatory developments worldwide, including China's strict automotive data security measures, underscore the strategic importance of facial and license plate data. China's framework classifies such data as critical to national security, requiring anonymization and strict processing controls. These developments signal an inevitable global trend toward heightened protection for visual data. For the United States to maintain its global leadership in AI, it must proactively establish comparable regulatory safeguards, ensuring the efficient and secure development of AI technologies while defining the international regulatory framework.

This issue extends beyond the automotive industry to all AI-driven vision-based technologies, including robotics, AI-embedded devices, security systems, and multimodal AI models. Without proactive regulation, the expansion of camera-based AI systems poses growing risks of intrusive data collection, unauthorized profiling, and national security threats.

To address these concerns, Syntonym recommends a risk-based approach for vision AI systems that develops tailored regulations embedding privacy and security in AI systems reliant on visual data, as well as mandatory privacy and security protocols that require anonymization of facial and license plate data, preventing unauthorized data exploitation while balancing AI innovation with national security and recognizing the role of lossless data anonymization in accelerating AI innovation, reducing regulatory burdens, fostering technological leadership and economic growth.

Attachments

Syntonym Comments to OSTP on AI Action Plan

To:
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Office of Science and Technology Policy
2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria, VA 22314

From:
Batuhan Ozcan
Syntonym Limited

March 15, 2025

RE: Syntonym's Comments on Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Syntonym respectfully submits the enclosed comments to the Office of Science and Technology Policy for consideration in the development of a new AI Action Plan which will define priority policy actions to solidify America's global leadership in artificial intelligence (AI).

Syntonym is an AI company dedicated to enabling enterprises to collect and process camera data essential for the advancement of vision-based AI technologies. Our mission in developing our lossless anonymization technology is to ensure that this progress does not come at the expense of individual privacy or the security of the systems reliant on camera data or camera sensors. Our multidisciplinary team of AI and machine learning engineers and researchers, privacy practitioners and legal and policy experts, focuses on developing technologies that balance innovation and data governance.

As a company with expertise in developing advanced techniques that can effectively alter facial features within images and videos, we have designed solutions that prevent unauthorized identification of individuals captured by automotive cameras while preserving the integrity and utility of the data for AI training and inference tasks.

Our proprietary solutions remove facial biometric identifiers from image and video data while maintaining their analytical value, ensuring that sensitive visual information remains protected. This approach mitigates risks associated with mass surveillance and unauthorized data exploitation by malicious actors while enabling the safe and privacy-enhancing use of automotive vision systems.

Our work in the automotive industry has reinforced the urgent need for stringent privacy and security measures in visual data collection. We are actively engaged with automotive technology developers in the United States and supporting other stakeholders in ensuring that automotive data collection projects protect the privacy of United States citizens. Through these collaborations, we assist industry leaders in

striking a crucial balance between the benefits of real-time visual data collection and the fundamental need to uphold both individual privacy and national security.

As demonstrated by the California Privacy Protection Agency's (CPPA) [ongoing efforts](#) to regulate the privacy practices of connected vehicles and related technologies¹ it is evident that regulatory frameworks will continue to evolve to address these challenges. The increasing regulatory focus on automotive data collection worldwide, particularly concerning facial and license plate data reinforced the strategic importance of visual data and the necessity of implementing privacy and security measures.

When monitoring international regulatory trends in automotive data protection and security, we have observed a growing emphasis on the security of automotive data collection and processing, particularly in China. To the extent of our knowledge and understanding, China has placed significant strategic importance on automotive data security as an extension of its national security framework.

In November 2024, several [sources](#) reported that the China Association of Automobile Manufacturers (CAAM) and the National Computer Network Emergency Response Technical Team/Coordination Center of China (CNCERT/CC) granted Tesla a "Vehicle Privacy Protection" certification. Tesla was the sole foreign automaker among the first batch of certified companies, having demonstrated compliance with China's strict automotive data security standards. These standards require, among other measures:

- The anonymization of external video and image data, including facial and license plate information,
- A default configuration that prevents the collection of in-cabin data,
- Local processing of any in-cabin data, and
- Clear notifications regarding the handling of personal information.

Additionally, under China's automotive data regulations, external video and image data containing facial information and license plates, are classified as critical data due to their direct link to the national security infrastructure. The justification for classifying this type of data as critical data is that the regulatory framework explicitly recognizes that unauthorized alteration, damage, leakage, or misuse of such data could jeopardize national security, public interests, or the lawful rights of individuals and organizations.²

The regulatory approach adopted by China underscores the strategic importance of visual data, particularly face and license plate information, in the evolving landscape of

¹"Modern vehicles are effectively connected computers on wheels. They're able to collect a wealth of information via built-in apps, sensors, and cameras, which can monitor people both inside and near the vehicle." Ashkan Soltani, CPPA's Executive Director.

² Driving Data Management, China Business Law Journal, August 13, 2024.
<https://law.asia/china-automotive-industry-data-compliance/>

AI governance. The heightened protection of such data reflects a global recognition of the national security and privacy risks associated with large-scale camera-based data collection. It is evident that similar regulatory measures will be introduced within the international framework as governments increasingly prioritize safeguarding sensitive visual data.

To solidify its global leadership position in AI, the United States should take a proactive stance in shaping the global regulatory framework in AI by integrating comparable safeguards into the new AI Action Plan. Establishing clear, forward-thinking measures on the collection and processing of visual data will not only ensure the efficient and secure development of AI technologies but also enable the United States to define the global regulatory framework and set the gold standard for data governance in AI.

This issue is not exclusive to the automotive sector but extends to all emerging AI technologies that rely on camera sensors, including robotics, AI-embedded devices and multimodal LLMs, smart devices, appliances, security systems and other camera-equipped or sensor-based technologies.

As these technologies become increasingly integrated into daily life, the risk of intrusive data collection, unauthorized profiling and mass surveillance by malicious actors grows exponentially. Without a proactive regulatory framework, the expansion of AI-driven vision systems could pose substantial threats not only to the privacy and civil liberties of American citizens but also to the national security of the United States.

To address these concerns, we respectfully recommend the AI Action Plan incorporates the following measures at minimum:

1. **Adopting a Risk-Based Approach for Vision-Based AI Systems:** Developing tailored regulatory measures for the specific nuances of vision-based AI systems, ensuring that privacy and security considerations are embedded from the early stages of technological development in emerging technologies that heavily rely on visual data, including autonomous vehicles, robotics, AI-embedded devices and other camera-based systems.
2. **Establishing Mandatory Privacy and Security Protocols for Vision-Based AI Systems:** Implementing clear guidelines that require the anonymization and secure handling of image and video data, particularly facial and license plate information, to mitigate the national security risks associated with mass surveillance and unauthorized data exploitation, and ensure that AI systems collecting and processing visual data adhere to strict requirements to protect the privacy of citizens and safeguard national security. Embedding privacy and security features not only strengthen national security but also reduces regulatory burdens, expedite AI model training, enhance data sharing capabilities and

unlock large-scale data monetization potential to contribute to technological leadership and economic growth.

Syntonym welcomes the opportunity to provide comments on this important matter. We appreciate the open and collaborative approach taken by the OSTP and the NITRD NCO as it develops a new AI Action Plan and submit these comments in support of a policy framework that not only fosters innovation and global competitiveness but also protects privacy and national security. We appreciate your consideration of our comments and remain committed to engaging further on these critical subjects.

Sincerely,

Batuhan Ozcan
CEO
Syntonym Limited

